

Rs for their functions in Epics and Issues in okrs |
-2	2020-10-19	E-group 50 minute draft review meeting
-2	2020-10-19	E-group discusses with teams
-1	2020-10-26	CEO reports give a How to Achieve presentation. Pre-Meeting and How to Achieve Presentation recordings are added to this page by EBAs
0	2020-11-02	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active
+5	2020-12-08	Review previous and next quarter during the next Board meeting

OKRs

1. CEO: Grow Incremental ACV (IACV)

Epic 1010

1. CEO KR: Complete 2 pricing and packaging changes supported by data. Issue 9210
1. CEO KR: 10 of 16 identified pain points in fulfillment are addressed and Zuora is the SSoT for subscriptions. Issue 9211
1. CEO KR: Improve growth efficiency so we are on track to reach 1.0 in FY22. Issue 9212

2. CEO: Popular next generation product

Epic 1011

1. CEO KR: Improve user experience => SUS score over 72.5. Identify and fix 7 transient bugs and improve quality tooling. Issue 9213
1. CEO KR: Increase conversion rate by getting 33% of active instances on EE, get 1B in MRARR, and have Projected GMAU in a dashboard for all 100% of the DevOps groups. Issue 9214
1. CEO KR: Ship the 5 minute production app, have a video that takes less than 5 minutes, and get 100,000 impressions for blog posts about it. Issue 9215

3. CEO: Great team

Epic 1012

1. CEO KR: 35 courses added across the company to the LXP system. Issue 9216
1. CEO KR: Complete 10,000 certifications across GitLab team members and the wider community. Issue 9217
1. CEO KR: Transition to performance based compensation increases. Issue 9218

How to Achieve Pre-Meeting Recordings

- Engineering
- Finance
- Legal
- Marketing
- People
- Product
- Sales

How to Achieve Meeting Recordings

- Engineering
- Finance
- Legal
- Marketing
- People
- Product
- Sales

SECTION: company/okrs/fy22-q1.md

This fiscal quarter will run from February 1, 2021 to April 30,2021.

OKR Schedule

The by-the-book schedule for the OKR timeline would be

OKR schedule	Week of	Task
-----	-----	-----
-5	2020-12-28	CEO shares top goals with E-group for feedback
-4	2021-01-04	CEO pushes top goals to this page
-3	2021-01-11	E-group propose OKRs for their functions in Epics and Issues nested under the CEO's Net ARR, Popular Next Gen Product, and Great Team OKRs. These issues and epics are shared in okrs Slack channel
-3	2021-01-11	E-group 50 minute draft review meeting
-2	2021-01-18	E-group discusses with their respective teams and finalize their OKRs
-1	2021-01-25	CEO reports post links to final OKR Epics in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval
0	2021-02-01	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active

OKRs

1. CEO: Grow Net ARR

Net ARR | Epic 1283

1. CEO KR: Leverage data to make sales more efficient. Issue 10306

1. Materially improve purchasing and licensing workflows to improve sales efficiency through fixing 16 of 16 Fulfillment pain points

1. Land vs. expand focus through securing X new logos and having ability to measure LAM (Landed Addressable Market)

1. Show growth from Account Centric marketing activities (ABM & Account Centric)

1. Analyze and iterate on FY22 plan with data from packaging

1. Every TAM has provided an adoption and/or expansion recommendation for an account based on the number of active users and product usage data in Gainsight

1. Find propensity to buy signals based on usage

1. Get xMAU data correct

1. CEO KR: Investigate new pricing and business models (GitLab Private, GitLab.com feature parity). Issue 10307

1. CEO KR: Accelerate Consumption on both Self-Managed and GitLab.com. Issue 10308
2. CEO: Popular next generation product

Epic 1284

1. CEO KR: Achieve System Usability (SUS) target of 75. Issue 10314
1. CEO KR: Increase Stages per User from X to Y. Issue 10315
1. CEO KR: Achieve X views from GitOps, Auto DevOps and 5 minute production app blogs. Issue 10316
3. CEO: Great team

Epic 1285

1. CEO KR: all managers complete a 9 box exercise and review with their managers. Issue 10317
1. CEO KR: GitLab exits a market and ongoing plans for engagement are clearly identified, agreed upon, and documented. Issue 10318
1. CEO KR: X . Issue 10320
1. CEO KR: Enterprises contribute \$X MRARR. Issue 10321
1. CEO KR: Evaluate and implement compensation strategy. Issue 10390

SECTION: company/okrs/fy22-q2.md

This fiscal quarter will run from May 1, 2021 to July 31,2021.

OKRs

1. CEO: New delivery methods launched

Epic 1422

1. CEO KR: Complete a functional prototype of GitLab Horse. Issue 11225
1. CEO KR: Complete Product & Development work for Cloud Licensing. Issue 11226
1. CEO KR: 5 'Upgrade features' available (when going from CE to EE). Issue 11227
2. CEO: SaaS Usability improvement

Epic 1423

1. CEO KR: Improve SUS to 72.5. Issue 11228
1. CEO KR: 10k product expertise certifications. Issue 11229
1. CEO KR: GitLab Region in alpha (sharded DB Gitaly style). Issue 11230
3. CEO: Sustained long-term growth

Epic 1424

1. CEO KR: 'DevOps Platform ambassador' marketing group reaching 100k people. Issue 11231
1. CEO KR: First Order Large SAOs back on the yearly plan. Issue 11406
1. CEO KR: Ensure the Talent Acquisition Team's capacity is aligned with the hiring goals by the end of Q2. Issue 11407

SECTION: company/okrs/fy22-q3.md

This fiscal quarter will run from August 1, 2021 to October 31, 2021.

OKRs

1. CEO: GitLab Managed future

Epic 1534

1. CEO KR: Drive 100% of identified SaaS First improvements to completion. Issue 12066
1. CEO KR: Launch Beta of Project Horse and onboard at least one customer (internal or external); Validate and deliver a horizontal scaling plan for GitLab (either database or application (Pod) scaling) aligned with Infrastructure, Engineering, and CEO. Issue 12067
1. CEO KR: Build Workspace core container in FY22Q3, enable Issue Types and move Labels from Plan capabilities, and setup path to enable enterprise critical instance level features for SaaS customers in FY22Q4. Issue 12068

2. CEO: Conversion from free

Epic 1535

1. CEO KR: Cloud licensing for 100% of new and renewing subscriptions. Issue 12069
1. CEO KR: Improve the current Golden Journey conversion rate from Verify to Release by 5%. Issue 12075
1. CEO KR: Increase funnel volume to drive pipeline. Issue 12074
1. CEO KR: Increase SaaS Trial conversion rate by 5% and Increase D14 namespace with 2+ SpO by 10%. Issue 12073

3. CEO: Even prouder to work here

Epic 1536

1. CEO KR: 90% of team members answering an internal survey say that they agree that:
 1. Feel comfortable delivering our Golden Pitch
 1. Feel comfortable speaking to our brand message
 1. [If attending] Contribute was a success
 1. We are at mile 3 or 4 of a marathon or ultra-marathon
 1. Love the new GitLab Brand
 1. GitLab pays competitively. Issue 12070
1. CEO KR: Meet hiring targets and have a diverse top of pipeline. Issue 12071
1. CEO KR: 7 certifications with more than 10,000 certificates issued. Issue 13
1. CEO KR: Graduate 2 internal projects from internal limited to public. Issue 12072

1. CEO KR: Raise monthly contributors from 80 to 120. Issue 12310

SECTION: company/okrs/fy22-q4.md

This fiscal quarter will run from November 1, 2021 to January 31, 2022.

OKRs

1. CEO: Encourage wider community engagement

Epic 1609

1. CEO KR: Develop a strategy to grow to 1000 contributors per month. Issue 12480

1. CEO KR: Meet quarterly objectives for hyperscalers and partners. Issue 12479

1. CEO KR: Achieve seven certifications with each more than 2,500 certificates issued. Issue 12481

2. CEO: Optimize GitLab Managed future

Epic 1610

1. CEO KR: Meet GitLab.com improvement goals (availability above 99.95%, free user Rol strategy). Issue 12482

1. CEO KR: Meet SaaS improvement goals (increase customer empathy project in engineering, x customers live with Project Horse beta, launch storage visibility). Issue 12483

1. CEO KR: Implement category creation plan. Issue 12484

3. CEO: Accelerate customer initiatives

Epic 1611

1. CEO KR: Improve SUS usability through completing 100% of quarterly initiatives related to Workspace, Learnability, and Foundations. Issue 12485

1. CEO KR: First order large SAOs on yearly plan. Issue 12486

1. CEO KR: Achieve X% of ARR on cloud licensing. Issue 12487

SECTION: company/okrs/fy23-q2.md

This fiscal quarter will run from May 1, 2022 to July 31, 2022.

OKR Schedule

The by-the-book schedule for the OKR timeline would be

| OKR schedule | Week of | Task |

| ----- | ----- | ----- |

-5	2022-03-28	CEO shares top goals with E-group for feedback
-4	2022-04-04	CEO pushes top goals to Ally.io
-4	2022-04-04	E-group propose OKRs for their functions in Ally.io. These links are shared in okrs Slack channel
-3	2022-04-11	E-group 50 minute draft review meeting on 2022-04-11
-2	2022-04-18	E-group discusses with their respective teams and polish their OKRs
-1	2022-04-25	CEO reports post links to final OKR in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval. Once approved, function objectives or key results directly related to CEO objectives should be aligned with the related CEO objective or KR in Ally.io
0	2022-05-02	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active and includes CEO level OKRs with consideration to what is public and non-public

OKRs

Ally.io is the source of truth for company OKRs. Since Ally.io is an internal only tool, public facing company OKRs are copied from Ally.io into the public handbook.

1. CEO: Increase ARR

- 1. CEO KR: Meet Marketing Qualified Lead (MQL) and First Order SAO goals.
- 1. CEO KR: Deliver final Matterhorn strategy and Zuora orders and ramps work in preparation for launch.
- 1. CEO KR: 60%+ of Q2 Self-Managed activations use Cloud Licensing.
- 1. CEO KR: Convert two features into Registration Features. Instrument them for measuring signup and conversion. Make a timeline for all features not on the pricing page.

2. CEO: Improve User Engagement

- 1. CEO KR: 150 active contributors per month in the quarter.
- 1. CEO KR: Implement user certification Beta with 300 beta users.
- 1. CEO KR: Achieve internal support service-level agreement (SLA goals) for a list of marquee customers, have recordings of internal fireside chats with 2 GitLab customers viewed by 50% of team members, and have 50 team members outside of the Support Team work on support tickets.

3. CEO: Leadership Development

- 1. CEO KR: Document Managing so Everyone Can Contribute (MECC) in the handbook. Use MECC handbook content to create a self-certified free course that can be used by non-team-members as well. Certify 1,000 team members.
- 1. CEO KR: Do a cost/benefit analysis for offering the right to migrate to 3 more countries (Germany / UK / US ?)
- 1. CEO KR: Launch Get Togethers with 80% of team members attending and achieve 80% team member approval for new engagement plan captured in the upcoming employee survey.

SECTION: company/okrs/fy23-q3.md

This fiscal quarter will run from August 1, 2022 to October 31, 2022.

Please note that Ally.io is the single source of truth for OKRs during the quarter. Company OKRs should map to the company OKRs in Ally.io to the degree that all information on this page is public and what is in Ally.io can include internal only information.

OKR Schedule

The by-the-book schedule for the OKR timeline would be:

OKR schedule	Week of	Task
-----	-----	-----
-5	2022-06-27	CEO shares top goals with E-group for feedback
-4	2022-07-04	CEO pushes top goals to Ally.io
-4	2022-07-04	E-group propose OKRs for their functions in the OKR draft review meeting agenda
-3	2022-07-11	E-group 50 minute draft review meeting. After, function OKRs are put into Ally.io and links are shared in okrs Slack channel
-2	2022-07-18	E-group discusses with their respective teams and polishes OKRs
-1	2022-07-25	CEO reports post links to final OKRs in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval
0	2022-08-01	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active and includes CEO level OKRs with consideration to what is public and non-public

OKRs

Ally.io is the source of truth for company OKRs. Since Ally.io is an internal only tool, public facing company OKRs are copied from Ally.io into the public handbook.

1. CEO: Increase ARR

- 1. CEO KR: [Internal only] SaaS Free User target.
- 1. CEO KR: Meet first order SAO and new logo goals.
- 1. CEO KR: Complete 2 key Fulfillment initiatives to improve systems and data architecture.

2. CEO: Improve user and wider-community engagement

- 1. CEO KR: Complete 10 resident contributor organization workshops.
- 1. CEO KR: Certify 1,000 team members and 10,000 wider-community members (external people) in TeamOps.
- 1. CEO KR: Have a successful Level Up launch with 5,000 registrations.
- 1. CEO KR: Improve key usability through delivering the basic design for addressing one major key cross-product workflow usability deficiency, completing the secure usability benchmarking effort, and resolving 40 S1/S2 SUS-impacting issues.

3. CEO: Complete activities foundational for scale

- 1. CEO KR: Deliver cross-functional revenue globalization priority frameworks and committed departmental action plans for top 5 countries / markets.
- 1. CEO KR: Increase the total number of URG Director and Senior Directors from 11.6% to 13.6%.
- 1. CEO KR: [Internal Only] Partnership milestones.

SECTION: company/okrs/fy23-q4.md

This fiscal quarter will run from November 1, 2022 to January 31, 2023.

Please note that Ally.io is the single source of truth for OKRs during the quarter. Company OKRs should map to the company OKRs in Ally.io to the degree that all information on this page is public and what is in Ally.io can include internal only information.

OKR Schedule

The by-the-book schedule for the OKR timeline would be:

	OKR schedule	Week of	Task
	-----	-----	-----
	-5	2022-10-03	CEO shares top goals with E-group for feedback
	-4	2022-10-03	CEO pushes top goals to Ally.io
	-4	2022-10-10	E-group propose OKRs for their functions in the OKR draft review meeting agenda
	-3	2022-10-10	E-group 50 minute draft review meeting. After, function OKRs are put into Ally.io and links are shared in okrs Slack channel
	-2	2022-10-17	E-group discusses with their respective teams and polishes OKRs
	-1	2022-10-24	CEO reports post links to final OKRs in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval
	0	2022-10-31	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active and includes CEO level OKRs with consideration to what is public and non-public

OKRs

1. CEO: Drive revenue through delivering customer results

1. CEO KR: Automate Dedicated

1. CEO KR: Enhance security through meeting FedRAMP and Yubikey targets

1. CEO KR: Make GitLab easier to buy by completing Fulfillment Efficiency and registration feature targets

2. CEO: Mature GitLab's DevSecOps Platform to improve product experience and increase user engagement

1. CEO KR: For each stage of GitLab, update Direction page to address delta with BIC competitor

1. CEO KR: Complete UXR and Designs for Feature Discovery Moments (FDM) and direction on ideal cross-product FDM experience

1. CEO KR: Activate 15 new Leading Organizations

1. CEO KR: Do FY24-Q1 OKRs in GitLab

3. CEO: Grow careers

1. CEO KR: Certify at least 100 GitLab Inc. team members and 1 person in each department as TeamOps Trainer: Level 1

1. CEO KR: Roll out a new leadership training module company wide (Elevate) and successfully enroll 15% in our leadership community in the course by the end of FY23
1. CEO KR: Increase URG management from 12% to 14% (globally)

SECTION: company/okrs/fy24-q1.md

This fiscal quarter will run from February 1, 2023 to April 30, 2023.

The source of truth for FY24-Q1 OKRs will be in GitLab.

OKR Schedule

In order to start dogfooding OKRs in GitLab, we are using a modified schedule for FY24-Q1 OKRs. We will resume the by-the-book schedule for next quarter's OKRs.

Modified Schedule for FY24-Q1

OKR schedule	Week of	Task
-----	-----	-----
-5	2022-12-26	CEO shares top goals with E-group for feedback
-4	2023-01-02	CEO shares top goals in okrs Slack channel
-4	2023-01-02	E-group propose OKRs for their functions in the OKR draft review meeting agenda
-3	2023-01-09	E-group 50 minute draft review meeting
-2	2023-01-16	E-group discusses with their respective teams and polishes OKRs
-2	2023-01-23	CEO top goals available in GitLab
-2	2023-01-23	Function OKRs are put into GitLab and links are shared in okrs Slack channel
-1	2023-01-23	CEO reports post links to final OKRs in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval
0	2023-01-30	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active and includes CEO level OKRs with consideration to what is public and non-public

OKRs

The source of truth for GitLab OKRs and KRs is GitLab. CEO objectives and KRs are captured on this page.

1. CEO: Increase adoption through customer results and increasing operating income (NGOI)
 1. CEO KR: Increase Ultimate adoption by X% and prevent churn by Y% versus current FY24-Q1 estimates
 1. CEO KR: Improve GitLab subscription purchase and management by completing 4 Fulfillment Efficiency initiatives
 1. CEO KR: Deliver Value Stream Dashboards MVC 1 Beta
1. CEO: Mature the Platform to be the leading DevSecOps platform
 1. CEO KR: Complete BIC comparison for each stage in internal handbook
 1. CEO KR: Complete delta BIC improvements for 5 stages, baseline all remaining stages
 1. CEO KR: Deliver 31 of 31 dropdown pajamas components, resolve 26 Usability Benchmarking

Issues (Secure, Release, and Create) and complete Usability Benchmarking for Verify

1. CEO KR: Achieve AI Assisted Code Suggestions MVC open beta (AI Assisted BIC)

1. CEO: Grow careers through encouraging a customer result mindset

1. CEO KR: Get closer to our customers through conducting value stream assessments with 100% of global top 30 customers by Ultimate ARR

1. CEO KR: Increase underrepresented group manager from 13% to >=15% (US)

1. CEO KR: Maintain GitLab's fast pace through delivering first [Elevate trainings and improving post-onboarding survey scores: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gitlab-OKRs/-/workitems/16>

1. CEO KR: Co-create with our customers by activating 20 leading orgs: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gitlab-OKRs/-/workitems/17>

SECTION: company/okrs/fy24-q3.md

This fiscal quarter will run from 2023-08-01 to 2023-10-31.

The source of truth for FY24-Q3 OKRs will be in GitLab.

OKR Schedule

| OKR schedule | Week of | Task |

| ----- | ----- | ----- |

| -5 | 2023-06-26 | CEO shares top goals with E-group for feedback |

| -4 | 2023-07-03 | CEO shares top goals in okrs Slack channel |

| -3 | 2023-07-10 | E-group propose OKRs for their functions in the OKR draft review meeting agenda |

| -2 | 2023-07-17 | E-group 50 minute draft review meeting |

| -2 | 2023-07-17 | E-group discusses with their respective teams and polishes OKRs |

| -1 | 2023-07-24 | CEO top goals available in GitLab |

| -1 | 2023-07-24 | Function OKRs are put into GitLab and links are shared in okrs Slack channel |

| -1 | 2023-07-24 | CEO reports post links to final OKRs in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval |

| 0 | 2023-07-31 | CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active and includes CEO level OKRs with consideration to what is public and non-public |

OKRs

The source of truth for GitLab OKRs and KR is GitLab. CEO objectives and KR are captured on this page.

1. CEO: Continue to win against GitHub with AI

1. CEO KR: Drive AI usage with X daily unique code suggestion users and a y% acceptance rate

1. CEO KR: Launch project Hamilton

1. CEO KR: Functions achieve their individual goals for team members completing a Dev Tool (GH) versus AI-powered DevSecOps Platform (GL) messaging certification

1. CEO: Reduce churn and contraction by delivering predictable high value to customers

1. CEO KR: Reduce churn and contraction to 70% of the ATR as compared to FY23-Q4

- 1. CEO KR: Improve CI adoption by increasing green ARR by X percentage points resulting in a Y% green outcome
- 1. CEO KR: Reduce ARR exceptions for cloud licensing to a maximum of 10% of Q3 new purchase ARR being exempted from sharing data
- 1. CEO: Make GitLab easier to do business with
 - 1. CEO KR: Launch enhanced supporting offerings, including PubSec 24/7 and assigned engineers, and onboard X new customers to Dedicated
 - 1. CEO KR: Ship temporary licenses capability
 - 1. CEO KR: Partner with hyper clouds to achieve two partnership goals
- 1. CEO: Continue to build a diverse team of top talent that we retain and grow
 - 1. CEO KR: Decrease time to open net new roles by 50% and fill 95% of Q3 roles within 75 days from requisition opening date
 - 1. CEO KR: Complete three agreed upon initiatives that result from employee engagement survey feedback. Specifically:
 - 1. Proactively share product and customer wins on a monthly basis
 - 1. Update values training to ensure our values & ways of working remain in focus and are understood by all team members
 - 1. Document and share outcomes from Q3 E-Group Strategy & LRO sessions to better highlight how resources will be allocated toward achieving company goals
 - 1. CEO KR: Graduate 50% of GitLab people managers from the Elevate program. Enhance program to ensure that GitLab values/unique way of working are referenced throughout the training modules or have a separate course

SECTION: company/okrs/fy24-q4.md

This fiscal quarter will run from 2023-11-01 to 2024-01-31.

The source of truth for FY24-Q4 OKRs will be in GitLab.

OKR Schedule

OKR schedule	Week of	Task
-----	-----	-----
-5	2023-09-25	CEO shares top goals with E-group for feedback
-4	2023-10-02	CEO shares top goals in okrs Slack channel
-3	2023-10-09	E-group propose OKRs for their functions in the OKR draft review meeting agenda
-2	2023-10-16	E-group 50 minute draft review meeting
-2	2023-10-16	E-group discusses with their respective teams and polishes OKRs
-1	2023-10-23	CEO top goals available in GitLab
-1	2023-10-23	Function OKRs are put into GitLab. Function representatives post links to final OKRs in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval
0	2023-10-30	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active

OKRs

The source of truth for GitLab OKRs and KR is GitLab. Team members have access to the OKR project: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gitlab-OKRs>.

SECTION: company/okrs/fy25-q1.md

This fiscal quarter will run from 2024-02-01 to 2024-04-30.

The source of truth for FY25-Q1 OKRs will be in GitLab.

OKR Schedule

	OKR schedule	Week of	Task
	-----	-----	-----
-3	2024-01-08	E-Group reviews draft quarterly OKRs for Yearlies	
-3	2024-01-08	CEO makes any desired modifications to draft quarterly company OKRs and shares them in the next week's E-Group Weekly agenda	
-2	2024-01-15	CEO shares top goals in E-Group Weekly and okrs Slack channel	
-1	2024-01-29	E-Group propose OKRs for their functions in the E-Group Weekly Meeting	
-1	2024-01-29	CEO top goals available in GitLab	
-1	2024-02-05	E-group discusses with their respective teams and polishes OKRs	
-1	2024-02-05	Function OKRs are put into GitLab. Function representatives post links to final OKRs in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval	
0	2024-02-05	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active	

OKRs

The source of truth for GitLab OKRs and KR is GitLab. Team members have access to the OKR project: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gitlab-OKRs>.

SECTION: company/okrs/fy25-q2.md

This fiscal quarter will run from 2024-05-01 to 2024-07-31

The source of truth for FY25-Q2 OKRs will be in GitLab.

OKR Schedule

	OKR schedule	Week of	Task
	-----	-----	-----
-5	2024-03-25	E-Group reviews draft quarterly OKRs for Yearlies	
-4	2024-04-01	CEO makes any desired modifications to draft quarterly company OKRs and shares them in the next week's E-Group Weekly agenda	
-4	2024-04-01	CEO shares top goals in E-Group Weekly and okrs Slack channel	
-3	2024-04-08	CEO top goals available in GitLab	
-2	2024-04-15	E-Group propose OKRs for their functions in the E-Group Weekly Meeting	
-2	2024-04-15	E-group discusses with their respective teams and polishes OKRs	
+1	2024-05-06	E-Group has a second round of alignment discussions in the E-Group Weekly	
+1	2024-05-06	Function OKRs are put into GitLab. Function representatives post links to final OKRs in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval	

| +1 | 2024-05-06| CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active |

OKRs

The source of truth for GitLab OKRs and KRs is GitLab. Team members have access to the OKR project: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gitlab-OKRs>.

SECTION: company/okrs/fy25-q4.md

This fiscal quarter will run from 2024-11-01 to 2025-01-31.

The source of truth for FY25-Q4 OKRs will be in GitLab.

OKR Schedule

OKR schedule	Week of	Task
-----	-----	-----
-2	2024-10-21	CEO introduces possible big themes and priorities for next quarter
-2	2024-10-21	E-Group agrees on top priorities for the quarter
-2	2024-10-21	CEO shares top goals in the okrs Slack channel
-2	2024-10-21	CEO top goals available in GitLab
-1	2024-10-28	E-Group propose OKRs for their functions in the E-Group Weekly Meeting
-1	2024-10-28	E-group discusses with their respective teams and polishes OKRs
-1	2024-10-28	Function OKRs are put into GitLab. Function representatives post links to final OKRs in okrs slack channel and @ mention the CEO and CoS to the CEO for approval
-1	2024-10-28	CoS to the CEO updates OKR page for current quarter to be active

OKRs

The source of truth for GitLab OKRs and KRs is GitLab. Team members have access to the OKR project: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gitlab-OKRs>.

SECTION: company/okrs/okrs-basics.md

What are OKRs?

OKRs stand for Objectives and Key Results and are our quarterly objectives.

OKRs are how to achieve the goal of the Key Performance Indicators KPIs.

They lay out our plan to execute our goals, which in turn support our strategy, and help make sure our top goals and how to achieve them are clearly defined and aligned throughout the organization.

Objectives are an aspirational goal to be achieved. They define what we're aiming to do, and they show how individual, team, or department work impacts the overall direction of GitLab by connecting work to overall company strategy.

Key Results are measures of progress against aligned objectives. They capture how we measure success in obtaining the objective. By achieving a Key Result (outcome), we create progress for the linked objective.

You can use the phrase "We will achieve a certain OBJECTIVE as measured by the following KEY RESULTS." to know if your OKR makes sense.

The OKR methodology was pioneered by Andy Grove at Intel and has since helped align and transform companies around the world.

OKRs have four superpowers:

- Focus
- Alignment
- Tracking
- Stretch

Fundamentals of Impactful OKRs

When writing objectives and key results focus on what you want to accomplish (the objective) and how you will measure the success (the key result).

To learn about the industry best practices for OKRs, how setting the right goals can mean the difference between success and failure, and how we can use OKRs to hold our leaders and ourselves accountable, watch John Doerr's Ted Talk.

When planning OKRs, be sure to consider OKRs at GitLab.

Criteria for Objectives

Objectives should be:

1. Ambitious - More than just "business as usual" or incremental change, an objective describes an aspirational yet attainable transformation, growth, improvement that significantly improves the current situation. A few examples:

1. Introduce disruptive innovations
1. Establish differences between GitLab Inc. and competitors
1. Be recognized as an industry leader in a category

1. Meaningful - A top priority that advances GitLab's strategy and greater mission; provides direction to departments, teams, and individuals about where we are going and how we are getting there.

1. Inspirational - By providing an aspirational yet meaningful target, empower teams to reprioritize work to focus on what makes the most progress against an objective; to accomplish this, objective should also be easy to remember.

1. Align Teams & Individuals - Need to be broad enough to be relevant to at least more than one department, team, or individual one level down, but also specific enough that the objective can be measurable by up to three key results; if associated Key Results are satisfied, Objective should be achieved.

1. For example, a product-related OKR at CEO level such as increase users by 100% would have the Product leader as the DRI but every other function would also need to contribute to achieve that KR.

1. Clear, Responsible Party - While aspirational objectives will often require collaboration and teamwork, they should have one DRI responsible for ensuring the completion the objective. This prevents diffusion of responsibility.
1. Focused - A person or team should have no more than 3 Objectives in order to focus on only the highest priority items; this also provides clarity on what we will not do in order to remain focused.
1. Transparent - Allow individuals, teams, and departments to see how their work contributes to the overall goals of GitLab. By sharing OKRs, individual, team, and departments are able to spell out their priorities and avoid having others disrupt focus with non-priority items.

Criteria for Key Results

Key Results should be:

1. Iterative - Aligned with our core value of iteration, a Key Result should focus on number of iterations or steps on the way to an outcome instead of just the outcome. Deliver x iterations instead of deliver y functionality.
 1. For example, if we need to create a certain number of experimental and beta features to ultimately get to 1 GA feature, break the KR down into iterative pieces such as deliver 16 experimental features, 2 beta features, and 1 GA feature to highlight the iterations required to get to the end result, instead of only focusing on the end result.
1. Aspirational - Ambitious but realistic stretch goals; if it feels uncomfortable, it's a good KR.
 1. If you achieve less than 70% of your KRs, you may be stretching beyond what is achievable. If you are regularly achieving 100% of your KRs, your goals may not be ambitious enough.
1. Linked - Be aligned to an Objective and be relevant to teams one level down; this alignment also allows KRs to easily roll down to become objectives one level down.
 1. KRs should not be too specific that the KR needs to be rolled more than one level down.
1. Clear, Responsible Party - one single person or team responsible for Key Result.
1. Influenceable - the Key Result owner (department, team, or individual) should be able to impact Key Result through the owner's actions.
 1. Example: an individual KR to change company-wide net retention is too broad; there are too many other conflating factors for an individual to determine impact. However, net retention could be appropriate KR for an entire department.
1. Time Bound - has a due date. At GitLab, unless otherwise stated, this is within the quarter.
1. Measurable - As Key Results provide the milestones for how we'll complete objective, KR should be either a qualitative (i.e. completed Y/N or number of steps of project completed) or quantitative (increased a metric by x) measure that can prove we accomplished the Key Result. Quantifying Key Results strongly preferred.
1. Mutually Exclusive - Measure one component of progress for an objective without overlapping with progress represented by other Key Results. Progress for one Key Result shouldn't count towards another Key Result.
 1. Example: A Key Result for number of transactions and a Key Result for average dollar amount of transactions are an example of mutually exclusive Key Results: one KR measures volume while the other Key Result measures quality of volume. On the other hand, a Key Result for total number of transactions and a Key Result for number of transactions from North America is an example of an overlap: progress gets 'double-counted' for both Key Result.
1. Collectively Exhaustive - Key Results should fully account for what's required to achieve an objective. If all Key Results are achieved, then, by default, the Objective must also be

achieved.

1. Few Words and Ubiquitous Language - As defined in Handbook.

You can score your OKRs against these criteria to determine whether your OKRs are effective.

How to Write OKRs

The following formula can be used to write objectives:

Verb + What you want to do + In order to/for/so that (what you hope to achieve or rationale for objective).

Objective Example: Increase awareness of company in the market in order to increase sales.

- Clear goal including rationale for pursuing that goal

The following formula can be used to write Key Results:

Verb + what you're going to measure + from "x to y".

Key Result Example: 100% of employees certified on OKR expectations and process.

For information on getting started with OKRs and writing basic OKRs, consider reviewing the OKRs 101 lessons on What Matters. The "6 Principles of setting OKRs" may also be helpful.

Teams should limit the number of OKRs they commit to so they have reasonable bandwidth to deliver. When planning OKRs:

1. Consider non-OKR commitments. While OKRs are the big commitments that the team is making, they do not supersede core team members responsibilities. This means retaining team capacity beyond OKRs for work that falls higher in a prioritization framework (example from product), such as forced prioritization items with an SLA/SLO. Meeting SLOs is not an OKR, as OKRs focus on what's different.

1. Other than core team member responsibilities such as those outlined above, all other major commitments should be prioritized through OKRs and consider team bandwidth.

1. If a team gets a request for a major effort within the quarter, they can change the OKR by following the guidelines how to change an OKR within the quarter

1. Plan for OKRs to be ambitious, but achievable within the team capacity that you have for OKRs. While OKRs are meant to be ambitious, you should aim to complete them and strive to hit the ambitious plan. We recognize that with ambitious planning some OKRs will not be completed, but it is striving and reporting on OKRs with the goal of hitting 100% that helps us accomplish strong results. We score individual OKRs as "on track" when they are at least 80% complete. In aggregate, we expect that the average completion score across OKRs is 70%.

1. Review cascading OKRs first and allocate time for those. Cascading OKRs are those at the Company level that need your group's contributions to be achieved. You should prioritize these first.

1. It is OK to push back on OKRs. If you can't prioritize a cascading or shared OKR due to more important work, contact the owner of the OKR and make adjustments so that it is achievable without your team's contribution, or remove it. It is OK to do this, with clear communication and collaboration. It is not acceptable to simply ignore the cascading OKR or shared OKR without clear upfront communication and prioritize other work instead.

1. When writing OKRs, focus on outcomes, not tasks, and make key results measurable.

1. For any OKR with a dependency, make sure to get commitment on the dependency with shared objectives. If you don't get commitment in the shared objective, make changes as needed to keep

to feasible OKRs.

Tips for OKRs that are scoreable

Your KRs should be statements that clearly indicate how you will score. For example, in FY21-Q4, the marketing team set a target of completing 5 experiments. It completed 4 out of the 5, but only one of these appeared to be successful. The marketing team initially saw this as a failure. Instead, it showed notable progress. 80% of experiments were completed. This was the stated KR goal.

We should aspire to set quantitative goals in which scoring is straightforward as a % of attainment (for example, X% of target ARR or logos). In rare instances, quantitative KRs are not possible or appropriate. For example, launching a new compensation program is hard to score without scoring guidelines. Does not launching = 0% attainment and launching = 100% attainment? What about hitting milestones in between? In these cases, note in the issue or epic how you plan to grade the KR at the end of quarter. In our compensation example, this could mean putting together a scoring guide such as this:

Milestone	Score
-----	-----
Complete compensation analysis	20%
Present plan to E-Group for feedback	40%
Get sign-off from Finance	60%
Complete comp refresh for all team members	100%

Please update scores in addition to status in Key Result Meetings.

Watch this video for a demo on how to updated progress in OKR management:

{{< youtube "kHkk-U22DBo" >}}

Example OKRs

Objective: Establish GitLab leadership in X area.

- Avoid · KR1: GitLab X becomes available in beta, including Y functionality in beta, with a path to general availability next quarter.
- Instead · KR1: GitLab X reaches 100k paid MAU by end of quarter.
- Avoid · KR2: Ship 10 components to support the use of X.
- Instead · KR2: 30% of GitLab users are able to use X with the components built.

This aligns with a focus on outcomes and business results instead of KRs tracking tasks or launches.

External examples

1. Examples from whatmatters.

OKR resources

- With Goals, FAST beats SMART
- Measure What Matters by John Doerr
- A Modern Guide to Lean OKRs

SECTION: company/okrs/okrs-in-gitlab.md

Watch this video for a demo on how to use GitLab for OKR management:

{{< youtube "OgJIYf4zXs" >}}

Creating Objectives

The objectives for the quarter are defined on this page.

To add new objectives in GitLab, follow the steps below:

1. In the GitLab OKRs project, navigate to OKRs by selecting Issues on the left sidebar.
1. In the top right corner of the Issues screen, select the down arrow next to New issue in the top right corner and then select New objective from the menu. Next, select the New objective button to create an Objective.
1. Enter a short but descriptive title for the objective then click Create objective.
 1. When referring to a division, use the division name, not the e-group leader's position. For example, use "Marketing OKRs" (not "CMO OKRs").
1. Select the objective from the list to open in an editable view and add more details:
 1. Identify the owner for the objective and assign them.
 1. Ensure that only one DRI is assigned to the objective. If there is a case of multi-ownership, it's likely that the OKR/KR can be simplified or broken down further.
 1. Identify the quarter for the objective and set the corresponding milestone.
 1. Add labels so objective is searchable/filterable:
 1. Add OKR label.
 1. Add division label to assign to the relevant division (i.e. Sales, Product, etc).
 1. Company OKRs are designated with a division::CEO scoped label.
 1. Only Product & Engineering cascade OKRs below division level, so for Product & Engineering OKRs, in addition to division labels, follow stage labels to add the Section/Stage/Group scoped labels to assign the OKR to the relevant parts of Product Hierarchy.
 1. Each part of hierarchy should have a label. For example, an OKR for a group would have a division label, a section label, a stage label, and a group label.
 1. Review the objective against the SAFE Framework to ensure it is information that can be shared. Review to ensure that the objective should not be limited access. If the information is limited access, use code name if relevant or link to a supporting issue that is limited access.

Creating Key Results

Each Objective will contain one or more sub-objectives or key results. Sub-objectives are only used to cascade OKR down a level in organizational structure while Key Results are the measure which helps us understand if we've met our objective and can be cascaded down a level of organization structure to become an objective one level down. Key Results must be created as part of an Objective and cannot be created independent of an Objective since Key Results should be linked to an Objective.

Since Key Results are the measure that helps us understand if we've met our Objective, Key Results are aligned to the same, single layer of the organizational structure as their parent Objective and not a Key Result for multiple layers of organizational structure. However, Key Results can be cascaded down from this single organizational structure layer by becoming Objectives in the next organizational level down - see Cascading OKRs.

To add new key results in GitLab, follow the steps below:

1. Navigate to the objective that you want to add a child key result to by opening the GitLab OKRs project, selecting Issues on the left sidebar, then clicking on the target objective.
1. Add new key result by clicking Add in the Child objectives and key results section of an objective and then select New key result. Use the SAFE framework to determine whether it needs to have limited access.
1. Enter a short but descriptive title for the key result then click Create key result.
 1. When referring to a division, use the division name, not the e-group leader's position. For example, use "Marketing KR" (not "CMO KR").
1. Select the key result from the list in the Child objectives and key results section to open in an editable view and add more details:
 1. Identify the owner for the key result and assign them.
 1. Ensure that only one DRI is assigned to the KR. If there is a case of multi-ownership, it's likely that the OKR/KR can be simplified or broken down further.
 1. Identify the quarter for the key result and set the start date as the first date of that quarter and set the due date to the last day of that quarter.
 1. Add labels so that KR is searchable/filterable:
 1. Add OKR label.
 1. Add division label to assign to the relevant division (i.e. Sales, Product, etc). Company OKRs are designated with a division::CEO scoped label.
 1. Only Product & Engineering cascade OKRs below division level. For Product & Engineering OKRs, in addition to division labels, follow stage labels to add the Section/Stage/Group scoped labels to assign the OKR to the relevant parts of Product Hierarchy.
 1. Each part of hierarchy should have a label. For example, an OKR for a group would have a division label, a section label, a stage label, and a group label.
1. Review the key result against the SAFE Framework to ensure it is information that can be shared. Review to ensure that information should not be limited access. If the information is limited access, use code name if relevant or link to a supporting issue that is limited access.
1. Optionally, turn on check-in reminders.
1. The key result now appears in the Child objectives and key results section of the corresponding parent objective.

Watch this video for a demo on how to create objectives and key results:

{{< youtube "QmOM7J0Tu0o" >}}

Cascading OKRs and how to Align Division OKRs to the company OKRs

Cascading is the process by which top-level company OKRs cascade down from company-level to division, department, team, and sometimes individual level.

The OKRs that are directly aligned with Company KRs should be tied to the Company KRs in such a way as to allow scoring.

At GitLab, we typically create OKRs at each level where some OKRs align with the levels above, but not all.

Based on the current methodology and feature set in the product, there are two ways to align OKRs to company OKRs:

1. Add relevant OKRs as related items. Most of the time, this is what teams use.
1. Have all relevant OKRs as children of a Company KR.

The second method should be used only if all relevant OKRs can be added as children, because Progress is automatically scored based on the children if any exist.

In the future, when manual scoring is available, a mix of the two methods can be used for a single KR.

If an OKR is related, but does not score towards the Company KR, edit the description to add a note.

Creating company OKRs

To allow for division, department, or team objectives to be added as child objectives or KRs, the Company key results should be created as an objective, not as a key result, as GitLab functionality doesn't allow for a KR to have child OKRs.

The Office of the CEO does the following:

1. Create the Company objective.
1. Create the Company key results as child objectives of the Company objective.

Once company OKRs are created, other divisions and departments following one of the two methods for team OKRs that score towards company OKRs.

Method 1: Add relevant OKRs as related items

Typically at GitLab, divisions create OKRs to automatically have progress score towards division objectives.

To indicate that a division KR should also show progress of a Company KR, add the division KR as a related item of the Company KR following these instructions:

1. Click on the relevant Company KR to add related items.
1. Click Add in the Linked items section.
1. Click inside of the following item(s) text field.
1. Find (enter text to filter) and select 1 or more objective(s) or KR(s) that should score to the Company KR.
1. Click Add to add the selected OKR(s).

Do this for all OKRs that contribute to company OKRs.
However, be careful not to link an OKR to multiple Company KRs.

When this method is used, the Office of the CEO will update the score manually based on the

scoring of all related items.

A hypothetical example where division KRs score directly to division objectives, and should also progress a Company KR:

1. Company Objective: Retain and grow top talent -- automatically scores from KRs including KR1
 1. KR 1: Have 10% of managers enrolled in leadership program -- manually scored based on related items
 1. Related: Sales OKR: Have 10% of managers enrolled in leadership program -- child of and automatically scores to CRO Objective
 1. Related: Marketing OKR: Have 10% of managers enrolled in leadership program -- child of and automatically scores to CMO Objective

Method 2: Add all OKRs as children of Company KR

This method should only be used if all OKRs that will score towards the Company KR can be children of the KR, because the Company KR progress is automatically scored based on its children. The hierarchy looks similar to this:

1. Company objective
 1. Company KR (a GitLab objective)
 1. Division objective
 1. Division KR
 1. Division KR

To add the division OKRs as children of the relevant Company KR:

1. Click on the Company KR you want to be the new parent for an objective/key result.
1. Click Add in the Child objectives and key results section of the Company KR.
1. Create team objective or KR as a child objective of the relevant Company KR (Company KR will be a GitLab objective).
1. If the team objectives or KRs already exist, find the objective or key result for alignment by typing the name of the OKR in the search bar that appears in the Child objectives and key results section. See documentation to add a child objective.
1. If applicable, add the team key results as children inside of the team objective.
1. Ensure they have an assignee, labels, etc. following guidelines on Creating Key Results.

A hypothetical example where division OKRs score directly to a company OKR:

1. Company Objective: Retain and grow top talent -- automatically scores from KRs including KR1
 1. KR 1: Have 10% of managers enrolled in leadership program -- automatically scores from child OKRs
 1. CRO OKR: Have 10% of managers enrolled in leadership program
 1. CMO OKR: Have 10% of managers enrolled in leadership program
 1. etc. (all divisions participating should be added)

Search and Filter OKRs

1. You can use the List view to filter by the assignee or by your team using labels. For

example:

1. This view shows all engineering division OKRs. Division::engineering label can be swapped out for any other division/stage/section/group scoped label.

1. This view shows all OKRs assigned to @sytses
1. You can bookmark or share the URL for future reference.

Watch this video for a demo on how to find the OKRs you're looking for:

```
{{< youtube "-wFJqtJQMHo" >}}
```

SECTION: company/working-groups/_index.md

What's a Working Group?

Like all groups at GitLab, a working group is an arrangement of people from different functions. What makes a working group unique is that it has defined roles and responsibilities, and is tasked with achieving a high-impact business goal fast. A working group disbands when the goal is achieved (defined by exit criteria) so that GitLab doesn't accrue bureaucracy.

Working groups are for important work that needs to be done quickly, when asynchronous work would be too slow.

Roles and Responsibilities

Required Roles

Working Group Directly Responsible Individual

This is the person ultimately responsible for the success of the Working Group, and also plays the facilitator role. A facilitator is responsible for running meetings and supporting the operational efficiency and success of a working group.

Please see the process below for details on the responsibilities of this role.

Executive Sponsor

The E-Group member who is responsible for staying plugged into the project, supporting the Working Group DRI (if necessary), and supporting escalations (if required). This is the E-Group member most interested in the results or responsible for the outcome. It will usually be the E-Group Member who owns the function that the Working Group DRI belongs to. E-Group Sponsors should be kept in the loop--especially when there are changes to timeline/scope, interdependencies that require alignment, or input needed. They will usually attend Working Group Meetings.

The E-Group Sponsor is responsible for helping the Working Group DRI to obtain funding needed for Working Group success. This is important as the E-Group is the level at which budget dollars are owned.

The E-Group sponsor also plays a key role in being a bridge to the rest of E-Group. This person should help to flag when related topics or updates should be brought to E-Group as an update or ask.

Functional Lead

One or more people who represent their entire function to the working group, regularly monitors the Working Group Slack Channel, creates issues for action items, serves as DRI for issues created, actively participates in meetings, volunteers for opportunities to further the Working Groups goals, regularly attends meetings either synchronously or asynchronously, shares information learned from the Working Group with their Functional teams, volunteers to take on action items, gathers feedback from Functional teams and brings that feedback back to the Working Group.

Optional Roles

Member

Any subject matter expert, attends meetings synchronously or asynchronously on a regular basis, regularly monitors the Working Group Slack Channel, shares information learned from the Working Group with their peers, and gathers feedback from their peers and brings that feedback back to the Working Group. A member may serve as a DRI for a specific workstream or activity.

Guidelines

1. An executive sponsor is required, in part, to prevent proliferation of working groups.
1. A person should not facilitate more than one concurrent working group.
1. Participation in some Working Groups requires a significant time commitment. Participants should be clear on their role and expectations for what they are expected to deliver. They should manage their time and capacity and quickly escalate if they feel unable to serve in or deliver in their role.
1. It is highly recommended that anyone in the working group with OKRs aligns them to the effort.

Process

Map out the Working Group

The first step is to carefully map out what type of activities are required for the Working Groups success. The DRI can get recommendations on who to involve, but they should first have a view of the jobs to be done.

Creating the Working Group

The DRI should identify key folks who will be members of the Working Group. They could do this in a few ways:

1. Reach out to the exec sponsor to help identify leads/contacts throughout the organization who could provide support
1. Reach out to functional leads from the stages identified as needing to provide support to

this effort

1. Include the folks who the DRI has already been working with on this effort, and ask them if they'd like to continue or have someone they'd recommend taking over
 - If cross functional data pulls/analysis will be required, please identify Data DRIs that can help. As an example, please see what was done for the Storage Limits Initiative
1. Solicit help on the respective stage's/team's Slack channel. The Features by Group page may provide some guidance

For example, if you know that this Working Group will eventually involve customer communications, you should ensure that the team has appropriate representation from the Customer Success department and that the representative is clear on the asks for both the team and the individual within the coming weeks and quarters.

Establishing team norms for the Working Group

The DRI should establish how the Working Group will work, including:

1. Frequency of meetings
1. Inclusivity of team members across the globe
1. Frequency of status updates for use in status tracker
1. Designating DRI for overall project management, including scheduling meetings and tracking project status
1. Create a Slack channel for collaboration. The Slack channel name should start with the wg prefix.
1. Gather metrics that will tell you when the goal is met
1. Organize activities that should provide incremental progress
1. Ship iterations and track the metrics
1. Communicate the results

The Working Group should follow the GitLab norms for meetings including:

1. Have an agenda
1. Document everything
1. Save time at the end of the meeting to take action items
1. Turn action items into merge requests or issues

Working Groups should follow the guidance outlined in Building High Performing Teams.

Working Group meetings

The DRI should stand up meetings at the cadence appropriate for the Working Group, depending on the urgency/importance and timelines associated. The cadence of meetings should map to how quickly you are moving and the amount of synchronously touch points needed for alignment and decision making input.

For example, you may have a high priority project in which decisions have been signed off on and change is not anticipated. Folks are clear on their roles and are staying on top of their activities as tracked in issues and epics. You may not need to meet more than once every two weeks to ensure alignment. Alternatively, you may be part of a project in which new deliverables are being reviewed daily and fast decisions have to be made. In this instance, it

is appropriate to meet more than once a week.

All meetings should have an agenda. Live Doc Meetings have Google Docs as the preferred tool for taking meeting notes in an agenda. Please use the Standup / Working Group Template as a starting point. If there's no agenda for an upcoming session, cancel the meeting.

Create a page in the handbook

Working Groups should have a page in the handbook in the current working-groups folder and added to the list of active working groups below. If you inherited an existing Working Group, make sure that the page is up-to-date. This ensures that other team members have a place to go if they are looking to learn about what you are working on. At GitLab, we're public handbook first, but if your work is not public, please use the internal working groups folder to keep the content SAFE.

Items to cover on your handbook page should include:

1. Name of initiative

1. Overview: what is this and why are we doing it?

1. Desired business outcomes, including exit criteria

1. Clearly outline risks and interdependencies. Flag mitigations and ensure that interdependencies are known and being addressed as part of the plan.

1. Key milestones and their delivery timeline

1. Who is involved. This should include who the DRI and Exec Sponsor (if there is one) are. Ensure that responsibilities for all participants are clearly documented and understood.

When possible, we work handbook first and start with a Merge Request. Google Docs can be used for drafting a proposal in which multiple folks need to collaborate in real-time. It may also be something that you'd consider when material is limited access. Once the confidentiality concerns are addressed and real-time editing is less crucial, the content should be moved to a Merge Request and the Google Doc should be marked deprecated with a link to the Merge Request.

Create issues and epics

Use issues to lay out the work defined, including the work defined in the handbook page. Use labels to denote progress (blocked, in progress, not started) and also highlight phases of work. The issues should be clear on what needs to be done, who the DRIs are from impacted teams, and the outcome expected. This applies to already ongoing work and work which is being newly scoped. If the team decides through an issue to make changes or implement new ways of doing things, document the change in the handbook.

You may also want to use an issue board as an overview of progress.

As work is being fleshed out and sub-projects are identified, some issues should be promoted to epics to group other issues that are part of the same sub-project. It's best practice to have an issue or sub-epic for each sub-project associated with the Working Group. Group sub-epics under one parent epic to track progress over time. As items are completed, close out the issues and epics and document progress in the handbook.

Like the handbook, issues and epics should be public by default. If an issue or epic contains

material that needs to remain internal, they should be made confidential or be in a project which is private. If an issue or epic can remain public, but a comment needs to be added that is internal only, you can use internal notes to allow the issue to remain public while having a confidential conversation.

Working Groups should leverage issues and epics in the projects, groups, and sub-groups that drive maximum efficiency. For Working Groups operating within the GitLab.com group on GitLab company related projects, the following resources are available:

- Per Working Group scoped labels
 - WorkingGroup::<NewWorkingGroupName>
- Working Group status labels for tracking status of issues and epics
 - wg-status::Not Started
 - wg-status::Ready
 - wg-status::In Progress
 - wg-status::Blocked
 - wg-status::Complete
- working-groups subgroup for organizing per Working Group issues, epics, and projects

Communicating status, updates, and changes

Communicate outcomes using multimodal communication. For example, you can use a primary epic to communicate current status and updates. The description of the epic should be kept up to date with the latest status, and a running log of updates should be left as comments to the epic. In the comment tag the respective E-Group sponsor (if applicable) as well as the relevant DRIs with @ mentions. Additionally, ping the link to the current status comment to the Slack channel created in establishing team norms @ mentioning the relevant folks.

Any material changes to the direction or plan for the Working Group should be put into the handbook page created, but general status and updates can be kept in the epic.

Changes to the timeline or schedule can have rippling downstream impacts. It is important to communicate these changes as early as possible to all relevant stakeholders. Shifting dates have the potential to negatively impact team members who may be tasked with communicating/guiding users/customers through these changes.

Trust Building

When a Working Group forms, it is important to build trust amongst the team members. This will help the Working Group function better, build credibility, and allow team members to be vulnerable with each other, if needed. Just as it's important to do the work itself, it's also important to take time for coffee-chats, activities, games, etc. that allow Working Group members to build a personal connection.

Disband the working group

Once the Working Group has served it's intended purpose, it's time to disband the Working Group.

1. Celebrate. Being able to close a working group is a thing to be celebrated!

1. Move the working group to the Past Working Groups section on this page.
1. Update the working group's page with the close date and any relevant artifacts for prosperity.
1. Archive the slack channel.
1. Delete the recurring calendar meeting.

Modifications to Process for Limited Access Communications

We make things public by default because transparency is one of our values.

Some things can't be made public and are either internal to the company or have limited access even within the company.

If something isn't on our Not Public list, we should make it available externally. If a working group is working on something on the Not Public List, working group team members should take precautions to limit access to information until it is determined that information can be shared more broadly. To highlight a few modifications to the process above:

1. Preparation

1. Determine an appropriate project name using limited access naming conventions.
1. Create an overview page and add the link to Active Working Groups. You can share limited information, but capture key team members, including the facilitator, executive stakeholder, and functional lead.
1. If working in the handbook, evaluate whether the page should be confidential or be housed in a new project with limited access. Consider working in the internal handbook. We use this when information may need to be iterated on or MR branches may need to be created in staging before it is made public. Outside of E-Group, temporary access may be granted on a project-specific basis.
1. Maintain a list of working group members and other folks who are participating in or informed of the project. This list should be available to all participating team members. Folks should not be added to this list until it is confirmed that they understand what can be communicated.
1. Ensure that each working group team member understands what can be communicated externally and internally.
1. Have private Slack channels that include folks who are directly working on the project.
1. Limit the agenda to a specific set of folks.
1. Communicate the results
 - Communicate results and progress to the direct working group or other key stakeholders to ensure that folks are aligned and have context on key happenings. Do not share sensitive information outside of private channels.
1. Proactively share information if the project is no longer limited access
 1. Notify widely of progress or exit outcomes when information can be shared more broadly.
 1. Evaluate which artifacts and communication material can be made internally available or public.
 1. If you were working in the internal handbook, follow instructions to make a merge request against the public repo.
 1. Transition members to public Slack channels and archive private channels.
 1. Deprecate private agendas. Link this to a new agenda document.
 1. Consider making GitLab Groups and Projects public or available to a broader audience.

Participating in a Working Group

If you are interested in participating in an active working group, it is generally recommended that you first communicate with your manager and the facilitator and/or lead of the working group. After that, you can add yourself to the working group member list by creating a MR against the specific working group handbook page.

If you are unable to attend the existing working group meeting due to time differences, you may approach the facilitator to arrange an alternative meeting.

Active Working Groups (alphabetic order)

- 1. Automotive Development
- 1. Customer Use Case Adoption
- 1. FedRAMP Execution
- 1. Frontend Technical Interview (internal only)
- 1. GCP Partnership